MENGYING WU
mengying_wu@hks.harvard.edu
617-800-4032
https://mengyingmandywu.github.io/

HARVARD UNIVERSITY

Address

Belfer Center 416
79 John F. Kennedy St
Cambridge MA 02138

Academic Appointments

Harvard University (2023 – Present)
Postdoctoral Fellow, Environment and Natural Resources Program, Harvard Kennedy School
Belfer Center & Salata Institute for Climate and Sustainability

- Project: *Decarbonizing aviation with sustainable aviation fuel*

Carnegie Mellon University (2022 – 2023)
Postdoctoral Associate, Department of Engineering and Public Policy
Visiting Researcher, Institute of Energy, Environment, and Economy, Tsinghua University (Field research in China as part of the CMU appointment, Summer 2023)

- Project: *Sustainable supply chains for multinationals with plants in China*

Education

Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Institute for Data, Systems, and Society
Ph.D. in Social and Engineering Systems (2017–2022)

- Dissertation: *Local official and polluter accountability in China's environmental inspections*
- Selected Graduate Coursework: Microeconomic Theory, Econometrics, Quantitative Methods, Organizational Economics, State, Society, and Behavior

M.Fin. in Finance (2015–2017)

Zhejiang University
B.S. in Applied Mathematics (2011–2015)

Fields

Environmental Policy and Politics, Climate Mitigation
Quantitative Policy Analysis

References

Professor James H. Stock
Harvard Department of Economics
79 John F. Kennedy St, Belfer 504
Cambridge, MA 02138
james_stock@harvard.edu

Professor Valerie Karplus
CMU Department of Engineering and Public Policy
5123 Scott Hall, 5000 Forbes Ave
Pittsburgh, PA 15213
vkarplus@andrew.cmu.edu

Professor Aaron Smith
UC Berkeley Department of Agricultural and Resource Economics
207 Giannini Hall
Berkeley, CA 94720
AaronSmith@berkeley.edu

Professor Henry Lee
Harvard Kennedy School
79 John F. Kennedy St
Cambridge, MA 02138
henry_lee@hks.harvard.edu

Fellowships

MIT Presidential Fellowship, 2017

Teaching

Science, Technology and Public Policy, Massachusetts Institute of Technology
Teaching assistant for Professors Noelle Selin and Kenneth A. Oye, Spring 2021 and Spring 2020

MIT Kaufman Teaching Certificate Program
Designed course curriculum for *Data Science for Decision Making in Public Policy* [syllabus], Fall 2020

Publications

Dynamic responses of SO_2 pollution to China's environmental inspections (with Valerie J. Karplus) [link] [code]
Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences, 2023

Working Papers

Policy Interactions and the Cost of Decarbonizing Aviation (with Kristen McCormack, William A. Scott, Aaron Smith, Jingran Zhang, and James H. Stock) [link] [code]
NBER Working Paper No. w34326; Revise and resubmit at the *Journal of the Association of Environmental and Resource Economists*
Featured in E&E News, Resources for the Future, and the HKS Belfer Center; cited by the California Legislative Analyst's Office (2026–27 Budget).

Lead author: Designed the equilibrium model, conducted the empirical analysis and coding, and coordinated the research team.

Effects of citizen scrutiny on polluter behavior in China (with Valerie J. Karplus) [link]

Why participate? Understanding the drivers of citizen complaints during China's environmental inspections (with Valerie J. Karplus and Lily L. Tsai) [link]

Work in Progress

State Climate Policy in a Federal System: Emissions Leakage, Costs, and Clean Fuel Design (draft forthcoming)

Inspections as Soft Signaling: Central–Local Learning in China's Environmental Campaigns (draft forthcoming)

Towards Credible and Cost-Effective Options for Sourcing Green Power for Supply Chains in China [link] *Policy brief for the Tsinghua Round Table.*

Seminars & Conferences

2025	Regional SAF Workshop for Massachusetts and New England
2024	North American SAF Conference and Expo; ASSA Annual Meeting
2023	ARCS Annual Research Conference; Roundtable on Corporate Carbon Neutrality Strategies (Tsinghua University)
2022	Northeast Workshop on Energy Policy and Environmental Economics
2021	Environmental Politics and Governance Conference; Duck Family Graduate Workshop; China Research Group Doctoral Symposium; Interdisciplinary Ph.D. Workshop in Sustainable Development
2020	ETH Academy on Sustainability and Technology; Institutional and Organizational Economics Academy; Duck Family Graduate Workshop in Environmental Politics and Governance

Academic Service

Student organizer, Sloan China Seminar Series, MIT (2017–2020)

Sustainability Leadership

Sustainability and wellness Chair, Westgate Apartments, MIT (2020–2022)
Research Collaborator, Sustainable PPE Initiative, MIT (2020–2021)

Languages

English (fluent), Chinese (native)

Software skills

Python, Stata, R, MATLAB, LaTeX